

23/05/2025

Strive, Surmountable, Clincher, Writ, Dovetails

1. Strive (प्रयास करना) (Verb) (strive) (Formal/Motivational)

- **Meaning (English):** To make great efforts to achieve or obtain something.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** किसी चीज़ को प्राप्त करने के लिए कड़ी मेहनत करना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old French *estriver* → **Middle English *striven*** → from Latin *strivus* ("to compete or quarrel") → **evolved to mean "to exert effort"**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Endeavor, Struggle
 - **Antonym:** Quit, Neglect
- **Connotation:** Positive (Associated with determination and perseverance)
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A student burning the midnight oil, surrounded by books, striving to crack a competitive exam.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

In biographies and motivational writing, *strive* is frequently used to highlight determination. For instance, "She strove against all odds to become a scientist,"

indicates relentless pursuit despite adversity. The word adds a powerful emotional dimension when describing personal battles, social movements, or business growth. Its formality makes it well-suited for self-help books, career guides, and speeches on resilience. Unlike 'try,' *strive* implies continuous, intensive effort over time with a specific goal in mind.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  We must strive for excellence in everything we do. (हमें हर चीज़ में उत्कृष्टता के लिए प्रयास करना चाहिए।)
-  He strives a cake for dessert. (Incorrect – "strive" cannot be used for objects or cravings.) (वह मिठाई के लिए "strive" नहीं कर सकता।)

- **Example + Grammar Breakdown:**

- They strive to create a better future for their children. (वे अपने बच्चों के लिए एक बेहतर भविष्य बनाने के लिए प्रयास करते हैं।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - They – Subject (pronoun)
 - strive – Verb (present tense)
 - to create – Infinitive verb phrase
 - a better future – Noun phrase (article + adjective + noun)
 - for their children – Prepositional phrase (shows purpose/beneficiary)

- **Common Collocations:**

- Strive for excellence, Strive hard, Strive toward goals

- **My Statement:**

- We should constantly strive to make things better in our life.
- She had strived a lot in her life before getting her dream job. ***
- She had striven a lot in her life before getting her dream job.
- Freedom fighters strive for the freedom of their nation. ***
- Freedom fighters strive tirelessly to liberate their nation.

- **My Notes:**

- The past participle of "strive" is "striven" (irregular verb), not "strived" (which is sometimes informally used but not standard in formal or academic writing).

- **V1 to V5 (Strive)**

- V1 (Base form): strive
- V2 (Past tense): strove
- V3 (Past participle): striven
- V4 (Present participle / gerund): striving
- V5 (Third person singular): strives

- **Example Sentences:**

- V1: They strive for excellence in every project.
- V2: She strove to overcome her limitations.
- V3: He has striven to meet all the expectations.
- V4: Striving for perfection often leads to burnout.
- V5: He strives to stay focused despite distractions.

2. Surmountable (सुलभ/काबू पाने योग्य) (Adjective) (sur-moun-ta-ble) (Encouraging/Optimistic)

- **Meaning (English):** Able to be overcome or dealt with successfully.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** जिसे पार किया जा सकता है या जिस पर काबू पाया जा सकता है।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *surmontare* ("to overcome") → **French *surmonter*** → English *surmount* + suffix *-able* = surmountable
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Manageable, Conquerable
 - **Antonym:** Insurmountable, Unbeatable
- **Connotation:** Positive (Suggests hope or solvability)
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A mountain climber nearing the peak with a flag labeled "Obstacles are surmountable."



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

In psychological and self-help literature, *surmountable* is used to reinforce the idea that problems, no matter how large, can be overcome. Statements like "Every challenge is surmountable with the right mindset" convey optimism. The word supports motivational frameworks and therapeutic guidance, especially in counseling settings. It's used in

leadership talks, parenting guides, and even strategic planning discussions to foster confidence and positive outlooks during setbacks.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  The challenges ahead are tough but surmountable. (आगे की चुनौतियाँ कठिन हैं, लेकिन उन पर काबू पाया जा सकता है।)
-  The cake is surmountable. (Incorrect – "surmountable" doesn't describe food or taste.) (केक को "surmountable" नहीं कहा जा सकता।)

- **Example + Grammar Breakdown:**

- Any financial hurdle is surmountable with proper planning. (उचित योजना के साथ कोई भी वित्तीय बाधा पार की जा सकती है।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - Any financial hurdle – Subject (noun phrase)
 - is – Linking verb (present tense)
 - surmountable – Predicate adjective
 - with proper planning – Prepositional phrase

- **Common Collocations:**

- Surmountable challenge, Seemingly surmountable, Surmountable risk

- **My Statement:**

- Every challenge is surmountable because in most cases things are settled in our mind which breaks confidence in advance. ***
- Every challenge is surmountable, as most obstacles exist in our mind and break our confidence even before we try.
- Bad habits are surmountable if rational decisions are taken as a form of early suppression. ***
- Bad habits are surmountable if rational decisions are made early as a form of intervention.
- Improper spending habits are surmountable with the help of strict budgeting and proper adherence.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

3. Clincher (निर्णायक तत्त्व) (Noun) (clin-cher) (Conclusive/Impactful)

- **Meaning (English):** A fact, argument, or event that finally settles a matter or decision.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** ऐसा तथ्य या तर्क जो अंतिम रूप से किसी बात को तय करता है।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old English *clenchan* ("to fix or fasten") → ***clencher*** (one who clinches a matter) → evolved to mean "decisive argument"
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Decider, Tipping point
 - **Antonym:** Doubt, Irrelevant point
- **Connotation:** Strongly Positive/Conclusive
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A courtroom lawyer presenting the final piece of evidence that wins the case – labeled "The Clincher."



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

In persuasive essays, political commentary, or business pitches, a *clincher* refers to the moment that seals the deal or finalizes an argument. For instance, "The clincher in his pitch was a prototype demonstration." It's often the most powerful closing statement or piece of evidence, used strategically in writing and speech. In sales and negotiations,

clinchers are critical in swaying decisions. The term is also used in journalism to highlight the turning point of a story.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  Her academic record was the clincher for getting the scholarship. (उसकी शैक्षणिक रिकॉर्ड ने स्कॉलरशिप दिलाने में निर्णायक भूमिका निभाई।)
-  He used a clincher to eat food. (Incorrect – “clincher” is not a utensil.) (वह "clincher" से खाना नहीं खा सकता।)

- **Example + Grammar Breakdown:**

- The photos were the clincher in the investigation. (तस्वीरें जांच में निर्णायक साबित हुईं।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - The photos – Subject (plural noun)
 - were – Linking verb (past tense, plural)
 - the clincher – Subject complement (noun)
 - in the investigation – Prepositional phrase

- **Common Collocations:**

- Final clincher, The real clincher, Marketing clincher

- **My Statement:**

- The military records acted as a clincher of violation of civil rights. ***
- The military records acted as a clincher in proving the violation of civil rights.
- The alibi presented in the court served as a clincher.
- They tried to forge a clincher and present it to the jury. ***
- They tried to forge decisive evidence as a clincher and present it to the jury.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

4. Writ (आदेश / लिखित निर्देश) (Noun) (rit) (Formal/Legal)

- **Meaning (English):** A formal written order issued by a court or legal authority.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** न्यायालय द्वारा जारी एक लिखित आदेश।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old English *writan* (“to write”) → **writ (legal document or written order)** → formal legal use expanded in Middle English
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Decree, Injunction
 - **Antonym:** Informal request, Oral statement
- **Connotation:** Neutral-to-Formal
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A courtroom scene with a judge handing over a sealed document titled “Writ of Habeas Corpus.”



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

In legal literature, *writ* appears in contexts like constitutional rights, administrative law, and civil liberties. A *writ of mandamus*, for instance, compels a government authority to act. It's commonly found in law books, judgments, and legal commentary. The formality of the term makes it crucial in explaining rights-based legal mechanisms. Journalists and

scholars also use it when reporting or analyzing constitutional or judicial decisions in democratic governance.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  The lawyer filed a writ in the Supreme Court. (वकील ने सुप्रीम कोर्ट में एक रिट दायर की।)
-  He wrote a writ to his friend. (Incorrect – “writ” is not a casual letter.) (उसने अपने दोस्त को "writ" नहीं लिखा।)

- **Example + Grammar Breakdown:**

- The High Court issued a writ against the illegal construction. (हाईकोर्ट ने अवैध निर्माण के खिलाफ एक रिट जारी की।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - The High Court – Subject (proper noun)
 - issued – Verb (past tense)
 - a writ – Direct object (article + noun)
 - against the illegal construction – Prepositional phrase (shows target)

- **Common Collocations:**

- Writ of habeas corpus, File a writ, Court writ

- **My Statement:**

- He was confused after reading the writ sent by the high court.
- The judge wrote a writ personally and addressed to send it to the local police station by tomorrow. ***
- The judge issued a writ personally and ordered it to be delivered to the local police station by tomorrow.
- The writ acted as proof of notice given to the builders who were working on a site listed as no-construction zone. ***
- The writ acted as proof that notice was given to the builders who were working on a site listed as a no-construction zone.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

5. Dovetails (मेल खाना / समायोजन करना) (Verb) (dov-tails) (Coherent/Harmonizing)

- **Meaning (English):** To fit or work together perfectly; to align seamlessly.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** पूरी तरह से मेल खाना या एक साथ अच्छी तरह से काम करना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Middle English → **dove-tail (woodworking term)** → symbolic use in 19th century English to mean “fit together neatly”
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** Aligns, Integrates
 - **Antonym:** Clashes, Conflicts
- **Connotation:** Positive (Harmony and coherence)
- **Pictorial Scenario:** Two puzzle pieces with "Ideas" and "Execution" written on them, dovetailing perfectly.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

Dovetails is a popular term in strategic writing, where plans, data, and systems are evaluated for compatibility. For example, “His marketing strategy dovetails with the company’s growth vision” implies perfect alignment. It’s used in management, organizational development, and design literature. It also appears in psychological and

philosophical discussions, suggesting congruence between beliefs, values, or practices. The word carries a strong sense of symmetry and purpose.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  Her schedule dovetails perfectly with mine. (उसका समय सारणी मेरे साथ अच्छी तरह मेल खाती है।)
-  I dovetail my shoes. (Incorrect – "dovetail" is not used for wearing items.) (मैं अपने जूते "dovetail" नहीं कर सकता।)

- **Example + Grammar Breakdown:**

- The proposal dovetails with our long-term goals. (प्रस्ताव हमारे दीर्घकालिक लक्ष्यों के साथ मेल खाता है।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - The proposal – Subject (noun phrase)
 - dovetails – Verb (present tense, 3rd person singular)
 - with our long-term goals – Prepositional phrase (object of alignment)

- **Common Collocations:**

- Dovetails with, Seamlessly dovetails, Strategy dovetails

- **My Statement:**

- My room partner's long term goals dovetails with mine, which is great news. ***
- My room partner's long-term goals dovetail with mine, which is great news.
- The enthusiasm of the team seamlessly dovetails with each other. ***
- The enthusiasm of the team members seamlessly dovetails with one another.
- When the strategy perfectly dovetails with the execution, then we can expect great results. ***
- When the strategy perfectly dovetails with the execution, we can expect great results.

My Notes: [Leave as Placeholder]